

believed to be two of the top core attributes of the metaverse. Interoperability, as per *TechTarget*, is the ability of different systems, devices, applications, or products to connect and communicate in a coordinated way, without effort from the end user.

In the metaverse, interoperability is the ability for different virtual worlds and platforms to interact with each other. It means that users on one platform can communicate and interact with users on another platform, as well as share data and content. If we have a lot of virtual worlds where you cannot go from one to the next or they are incompat-

ible with each other, that is not going to be a pleasant experience. So, the very nature of a connected system requires that there be openness.

When operators build their metaverse, one can anticipate a constant battle across the technology stack between centralised and proprietary versus decentralised and open standards and protocols. It will benefit users if the metaverse builders collaborate on interoperable, open standards on privacy, security, blockchain, data storage, AI (artificial intelligence), spatial computing, and so on.

For an open, interoperable metaverse to see its potential, it is

vital for consortiums of different enterprises, both centralised and decentralised, to collaborate on protocol standards. Much as the internet's globally accepted standards of DNS (domain name system) and IP (internet protocol) catalysed its adoption, the metaverse requires standards for graphical, transactional, compute, and network capabilities.

## Metaverse open standards

In the initial stages of development, there are already some projects working on creating an interoperable metaverse. One of them is the Open Metaverse Foundation, which

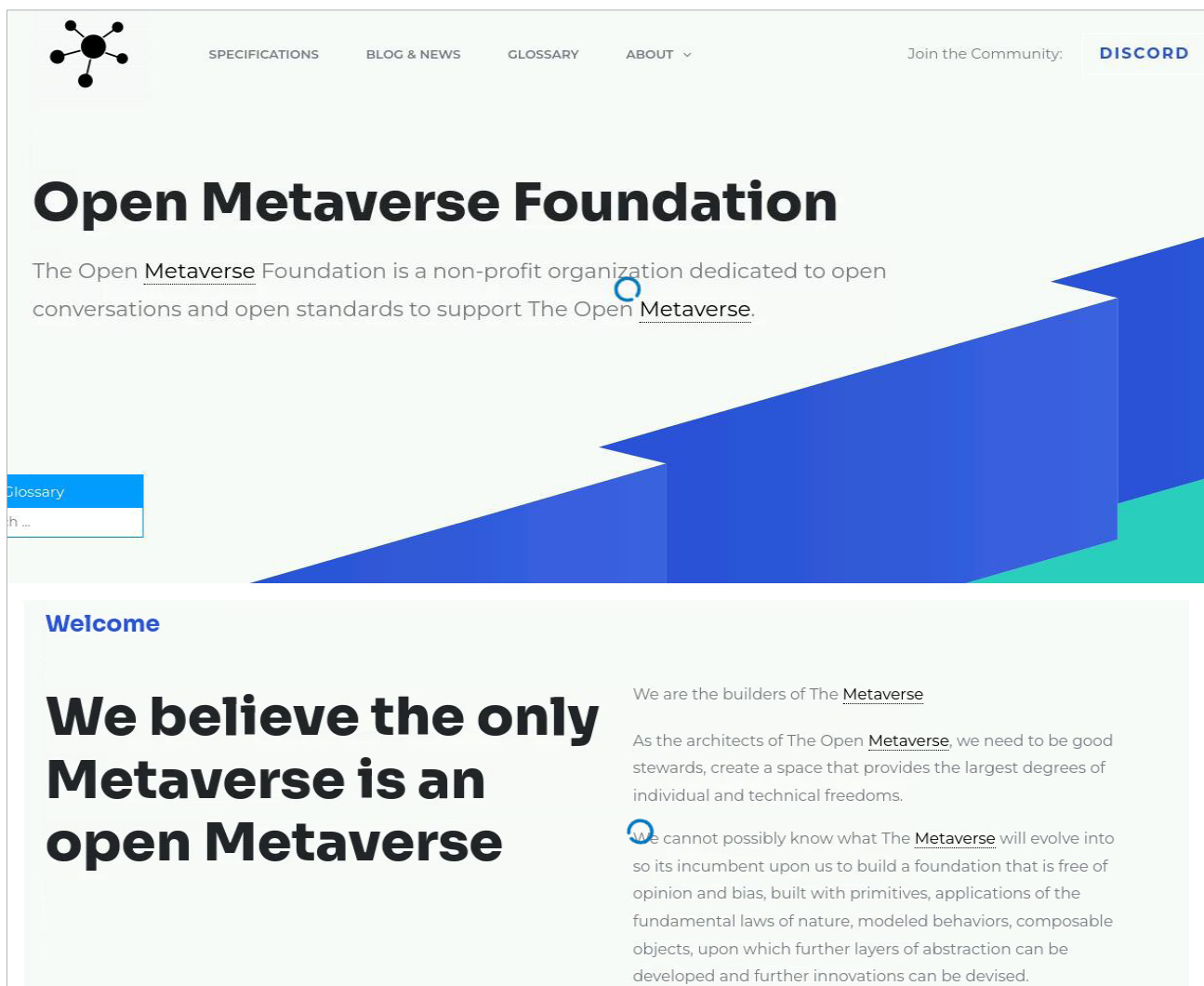


Fig. 1: Home page of the Open Metaverse Foundation